
Event Agenda

2025 NDLA/SDLA/MPLA Tri-Conference

Wednesday, October 01, 2025

NDLA Executive Board Meeting

9:00 AM – 10:30 PM | Location: Hawk

Speaker



Andrea Placher (she/her)

Library Director | Williston Community Library

MPLA Executive Board Meetings

10:30 AM – 12:00 PM | Location: Bluebird/Finch

Speaker



Robin Hastings

Library Services Consultant | Northeast Kansas Library System

Keynote: Laura Numeroff

12:30 PM – 1:30 PM | Location: Ballroom

Workshop 1: Elevating School Libraries

1:30 PM – 3:30 PM | Location: Hawk

Speakers



Sara Kelly Johns

Instructor | Syracuse University iSchool, School Library Program



Susan D. Ballard

Consultant & Educator | Independent

Workshop 2: Trauma Informed Services

1:30 PM – 3:30 PM | Location: Bluebird/Finch

Speaker



Margaret Ann Paauw

Assistant Professor | Eastern Michigan University

Workshop 3: A Librarian's Guide to Consumer Health

1:30 PM – 3:30 PM | Location: Cardinal/Hummingbird

This course covers the health information seeking behavior of consumers and the role of the librarian in the provision of health information for the public. Learn about the evolution of consumer health, health literacy and the e-patient, and expand your knowledge of top consumer health websites. We will discuss creative ideas for health information outreach in libraries and wrap up by exploring effective marketing approaches and developing an elevator speech.

After getting familiar with the wonderful resources available from the Network of the National Library of Medicine (NNLM) we will learn about local health partners and how to partner with them to leverage resources, learn about promoting health resources and programming and discuss how to advocate for libraries' role in health promotion in your community.

Perfect for small or rural public libraries interested in becoming trusted health information hubs, this workshop equips participants with the tools to confidently connect their communities to reliable online and local health resources.

Objectives:

- Learners will be able to explain how to review and compare consumer health resources and

demonstrate knowledge of reputable, reliable resources through online class discussions and activities.

- Learners will apply health literacy and public health content knowledge to use NLM resources to meet their unique community needs.
- Learners will interpret demographic reports and recommend solutions.
- Learners will learn how to identify and connect with local health resources
- Utilizing NLM resources, learners will develop a consumer health program that their library can use for promotion and community outreach.

Speakers



Ruby Nugent

Biomedical Research Librarian | National Jewish Health Tucker Medical Library



Maggie Shawcross

Teaching and Learning Librarian | University of Northern Colorado

Contributor



Alex Henigman

Medical Librarian | University of Missouri - Columbia

Keynote: Denise Lajimodiere

3:45 PM – 5:00 PM | Location: Ballroom

Speaker



Tammy Kruger

Dine Arounds

5:00 PM – 7:00 PM

Chaaras & Tequila

5:00 PM – 7:00 PM

Mexican Food

Speaker



Elizabeth Fox

Lobbying for Libraries | South Dakota State University

Blue Moose

5:00 PM – 7:00 PM

Menu: <https://www.thebluemoose.net/menu>

Our signature homemade dishes – from our perfectly prepared walleye to our one of-a-kind spinach con queso – make us one of the Upper Midwest's most original eateries.

Our menu is rounded out with fresh salads and wraps, hearty burgers and sandwiches, classic soups, and delicious appetizers.

It's fine dining with a casual, Northwood flair.

Join us for a cold drink (or two) and a freshly prepared meal that's long on taste and big on flavor.

The fun is always red hot at the Blue Moose Bar & Grill.

Speaker



Dylan Gonser

Adult Services Librarian -Outreach Lead | Grand Forks Public Library

House of Punjab

5:00 PM – 7:00 PM

Menu: <https://www.houseofpunjabgf.com/menu>

Authentic Indian Cuisine

Speaker



Zeineb Yousif

Digital Initiatives Librarian | University of North Dakota

Ely's Ivy

5:00 PM – 7:00 PM

Menu: <https://elysivy.com/menu>

Farm to Table Dining featuring North Dakota high quality raised, processed and aged Angus Steaks, Bison, and lamb. Minnesota chicken, duck, pheasant, grass fed beef, walleye, and pasture raised pork. Year round local lettuces. Uses local flour and grains to bake all bread for sandwiches and burgers.

Speaker



Kristen Borysewicz

Interim Head of Ask Us and Reference | University of North Dakota

Rhombus Guys Pizza

5:00 PM – 7:00 PM

Menu: <https://order.toasttab.com/online/rhombus-guys-gf>

In spring of 2002, Rhombus House of Pizza was born. Matt and Arron decided to bring long time friend Levi Kraft into the now successful business, developing a small yet dedicated staff. Through trial and error, the team was able to perfect their definition of the perfect slice. Eventually, the Grand Forks Herald caught wind of the new guys on the block and decided to write a piece on the trio that were changing the pizza scene in the Red River Valley. Following the vastly successful Herald article, business skyrocketed for the Rhombus team. After opening a location in Thief River Falls, there was a lot to be learned about what it really took to run a standalone restaurant successfully. Levi eventually decided to leave the business to focus on starting his family, and eventually Matt and Arron decided it was time to open a location in Grand Forks, ND.

Speaker



Traci Lund

Director | Divide County Library

Toasted Frog

5:00 PM – 7:00 PM

Menu: <https://toastedfrog.com/food-menu-grand-forks/>

Join us at The Toasted Frog in Grand Forks for an evening of culinary delight in an upscale yet relaxed setting. Indulge in our signature fried cheesy pickles, a local favorite, or explore our eclectic menu featuring everything from gorgonzola butter filet mignon to mahi-mahi tacos, all paired with our extensive wine and martini list.

Speaker



Erin Renee Wahl

Dr. | New Mexico State University

Little Bangkok

5:00 PM – 7:00 PM

<https://www.littlebangkok.net/grand-forks#OurMenu>

Speaker



Jenna Kahly

Director | West Fargo Public Library

Library Tour & Reception: Grand Forks Public Library

7:00 PM – 8:00 PM | Location: 2110 Library Cir, Grand Forks, ND 58201

Speaker



Wendy Wendt

Director | Grand Forks Public

MPLA Hot Tub Round Table

8:00 PM – 10:00 PM

Speaker



Robin Hastings

Library Services Consultant | Northeast Kansas Library System

Thursday, October 02, 2025

Keynote: R.L. Stine

9:00 AM – 10:00 AM

Exhibits Open!

10:15 AM – 11:00 AM

Lightning Rounds

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM | Location: Oriole

My Thoughts Tend to Be: How Can I Do More? - Empowering Staff through professional development and Lobbying for Libraries

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

Attendees will hear about the Certificate in Library Studies program and how one library system is going the extra mile by creating in-person study groups for their participating staff to enhance their engagement with materials and ideas discussed in the course. The program is especially designed for non-MLIS library staff. These workers make up as much as 75% of all full-time public library employees, and their institutional knowledge and experience make them invaluable to their libraries and communities. This online continuing education program explores essential principles of library work and provides insight into the contributions libraries make to our society.

Lobbying for Libraries - This session will talk about techniques used by South Dakota libraries to convince our state government to keep our state library and federal funding and to not criminalize teachers and librarians for letting minors access materials that someone considers "harmful." When we work together, we are powerful, learn the techniques South Dakotans used in our wins.

Speakers



Liz Hartnett

Instructor | School of Information Science, University of South Carolina



Elizabeth Fox

Lobbying for Libraries | South Dakota State University

Beyond Translation: Building an Inclusive Spanish Language Collection and Going Underground: Zines as Alternative Information Channels

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

How do you build a Spanish-language collection that goes beyond translation and truly connects with the community? Recognizing the need for a vibrant and culturally relevant Spanish-language collection, the Santa Fe Community College Library launched a project to assess its existing materials, curate a collection of resources that reflect the diverse Spanish-speaking community, and develop an entirely new collection of resources. This session will explore the challenges encountered, share key insights gained, and highlight valuable resources to support the ongoing development the collection.

Going Underground - In an attempt to decrease the impact of book bans on libraries, this presentation will introduce the zine as an alternative channel of information that can continue to inform patrons and support marginalized communities. At the end of this presentation, attendees will (1) have the knowledge to start building their own zine collection, (2) begin researching and developing their own alternative information channels, and (3) be able to successfully create an 8-page zine.

Speakers



Val Nye

Library Director | Santa Fe Community College



Abbott Steuhm

Research & Scholarship Librarian | Dakota State University

Perspectives of Sustainability in Archives and Metadata Wrangling at Scale: One Librarian's Quest to Tame Our Electronic Theses Collection

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

In 2024, Wahl launched a national survey designed to investigate American archivists' understanding of sustainability in general and, more specifically, the United Nations' Sustainable Development Goals. This presentation will report on the results of that study and imagine a path forward in sustainability for U.S. archivists based on the responses.

Metadata Wrangling - What does eight years, partnerships with your ILL and Cataloging departments, and several student workers get you? Amazing progress on your quest to digitize 140 years worth of theses and dissertations completed at your university! But also...real quality control struggles. This presentation will share lessons learned from a large scale retrospective digitization project including how to coordinate across departments and staffing changes, avoid duplicating effort, and use digital tools like Excel and OpenRefine to identify and correct metadata errors after the fact.

Speakers



Erin Renee Wahl

Dr. | New Mexico State University



Zeineb Yousif

Digital Initiatives Librarian | University of North Dakota

Quietly Queer Programming and the Value of Queer Literature

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

While many libraries would love to be full-throated supporters of the LGBTQ+ community, unfortunately many rural libraries in conservative areas find their hands are tied if they so much glance at a rainbow. These situations call for subtlety. In other words, Quietly Queer Programs! This lightning session will provide LGBTQ+ inclusive programming ideas for librarians to implement in their own libraries, focusing on color, self-expression, and of course, plausible deniability.

Value of Queer Literature - Fiction and Nonfiction materials from the LGBTQ2S+ community has historically been criticized, challenged, or ignored. In recent years, we have seen more and more of this literature flood our shelves from patron requests. So, what is it about this material? In this session, I will explore what value it has to the reader as well as to history and literature.

Speaker



Kelsey Riggs

Reference & Instructional Librarian | Bismarck State College

Poster Session

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

Applying Social Science Methods to Evaluate AI-Generated Metadata

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

This presentation explores how established social science research methodologies can effectively evaluate AI-generated metadata quality. Beginning in the spring of 2023, the author began a project to create diverse types of metadata, evaluate it, and implement it on library websites and in library systems. She discovered creating metadata was not difficult, but it was difficult to determine the quality and accuracy of the metadata. How good did the metadata need to be to share it with patrons?

This presentation will explore multiple evaluation methods and the results of these methods. The first evaluation methods include case studies and observational techniques to analyze how well generative AI could assign Dewey classifications and Library of Congress subject headings to physical books.

The next methodological approach includes quantitative assessment using rubrics and qualitative investigation through surveys and interviews. Student workers created abstracts and keywords for electronic theses and dissertations and then evaluated their own work using these approaches.

Finally, the presentation will explore the use of comparative analysis to see if human-created, AI-created or human assisted by AI metadata is superior. Future research seeks to evaluate the quality of AI-created metadata by subject and to see if cases of bias occur.

Speaker



Jenny Bodenhamer

Assistant Department Head | Oklahoma State University

Combatting Imposter Syndrome in a New Library Position

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

This past year, Karlene moved into a reference position and went through a period of self doubt. This presentation will provide resources for others going through transitions at work, including academic resources and ways to calm and reassure yourself.

Speaker



Karlene Clark

Education and Human Services Librarian | University of North Dakota

Escape Rooms for Teens

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

How to write your own library appropriate escape room or borrow mine!

Speaker



Pam Carswell

Teen Librarian | Minot Public Library

AI Literacy Starts Here: Supporting Students and Patrons with Confidence

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

Artificial Intelligence isn't just the future—it's today's opportunity for educators and librarians to lead with curiosity, clarity, and care. This poster session introduces practical, educator-friendly AI tools that support instruction, engagement, and digital literacy across school and public library settings.

What you'll discover:

- Easy-to-use AI tools for lesson planning, resource creation, and library programming
- Curated resources to teach AI literacy to students and patrons
- Opportunities to bring this presentation to your school or library—customized for your community

Whether you're AI-curious or ready to dive in, this poster session offers hands-on ideas, inclusive strategies, and a warm invitation to explore AI with confidence.

Speaker



Lesley Allan

Instructional Design and Development Coordinator | Fables and Fabrications

How to hold an Acrylic Paint Pour program

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

Acrylic paint pouring is a style of painting that saw a rise in popularity in the mid-2010's and it a great way for anyone to try their hand at art, even if they "don't feel like they're creative or an artist." I like to encourage everyone to give paint pouring a try because you don't need to be an artist to enjoy the process of making art. It involves thinning down paint and adding simple "ingredients" such as glue, to make acrylic paint flow freely. It can be done using inexpensive supplies and patrons are always impressed by their creations. The possible outcomes of a paint pour are endless and unique. A wide variety of age ranges can participate in paint pouring, one summer we modified the activity to be a mini paint pouring kit as a take & make for our patrons. My poster would detail the supplies needed, and the ideal way to set up your space for a successful paint pour, along with examples of previous paint pours.

Speaker



Brandy Helm

Information Services Associate | Grand Forks Public Library

If You Host It - Will They Come? Lessons from a year of programming in an academic library

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

The poster will provide a look at three new library programs that were introduced to students at Dakota State University in the Fall 2024 semester. Poster will detail how the library prepped for the programs, how things proceeded over the academic year, and both failures and successes of each program. A final section will offer takeaways and changes that could be made in the future. The programs were a textiles/fabrics group, a writing group (separate from the writing center on campus), and a young adult book club.

Speaker



Taylor Cline

Library Associate | Dakota State University

ND Dept. of Public Instruction, Legendary Learners

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

Speaker



Taylor Olsen

ND Dept. of Public Instruction

Making the Federal Case: The Arc of North Dakota, Disability Rights, and Advocacy

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

In 1980, The Arc of North Dakota sued the state of North Dakota in U.S. Federal District Court regarding the treatment of, and conditions surrounding, the nature of care of North Dakotans with intellectual and developmental disabilities in the Grafton State School and the San Haven State Hospital. When the case was closed in 1996, it brought about fundamental and long-lasting changes across the state.

In 2024, The Arc of North Dakota chose to deposit their records related to the lawsuit with the Elwyn B. Robinson Department of Special Collections at the University of North Dakota's Chester Fritz Library. Special Collections already holds the papers of Judge Bruce Van Sickle, the federal judge presiding over the case, as well as the papers of several state politicians involved with the case. The addition of the Arc's collection represents an unprecedented opportunity to document the legal case, and subsequent changes, surrounding the state of North Dakota's treatment of the intellectually and developmentally disabled.

Through this poster, the presenters will examine how the collection originated, the initial discussions surrounding the archival donation, and possible future growth of the collection, hopefully including donations from individuals with lived experience or their families. The presenters will also share how the collections support the strategic goals of the University of North Dakota.

Promoting Poetry in Your Library

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

Poetry often represents a small section in libraries and may be overlooked by all but the most dedicated poetry enthusiasts. This sometimes leaves many poetry sections devoid of more recent modern poets. This poster seeks to encourage and inform on how to build up poetry collections by recommending modern poets and how to grow a reader base along the way with events and displays.

Speaker



Laura Kroeker

Library Associate | Rapid City Public Library

Providing Comprehensive Library Access for Hybrid and Remote Researchers

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

As hybrid and remote work continues, special libraries are continually evolving to meet the needs of their communities. This includes remote and hybrid researchers at the University of North Dakota's Energy & Environmental Research Center (EERC). While the EERC is physically located in eastern North Dakota, EERC employees are scattered throughout MPLA states. Using embedded librarianship principles, the EERC's Library & Information Services team fulfills complex and time-sensitive information needs by providing creative solutions and building partnerships with researchers.

Speaker



Tressa M Graves

Librarian & Archivist | University of North Dakota. Energy & Environmental Research Center

Strategies for Combatting Health Misinformation

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

- While health misinformation has existed nearly since humans started practicing medicine, the strategies by which health misinformation spreads have changed in the age of social media, allowing for misinformation and conspiracies to spread more widely and cause more harm. While systemic changes are needed to lessen the societal impact of health misinformation, there are also actions we can take in our day to day lives, both personally and professionally, to help decrease the spread of health misinformation.

- Outline

- A brief history of health misinformation
- Current methods of spread
- A review of the literature on actions to decrease the spread of health misinformation
- Actions individuals can take to decrease the spread of health misinformation

Speaker



Caroline Allen

Librarian | University of Iowa Healthcare, Department of Ophthalmology and Visual Sciences

Tell Me More: Demystifying Medical Librarianship

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

Medical and health sciences librarians make up approximately 21% of the entire library profession, yet many are unsure of what this specialized area of librarianship looks like. Others may be new to the profession or looking for a change in discipline and are hesitant to pursue an area of librarianship that seems to require experience of a knowledge base they are interested in, but do not have specialized skills required to fill their roles in providing health information. This session aims to: introduce attendees to what the pathway to medical librarianship might look like, provide information about the types of education and training needed and where to find it, and explore examples of potential settings and roles individuals can find themselves in, and to encourage and empower attendees by providing some resources and tools they can use to pursue a career as medical librarians.

Speaker



Ruby Nugent

Biomedical Research Librarian | National Jewish Health Tucker Medical Library

The (Library) Magic of a Stuffy Sleepover

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

For fans of children's programming and Toy Story. This poster will show and describe how I went about planning and executing a Stuffy Sleepover event at the Williston Community Library. From preparation tactics and marketing the event, to day-of jitters, all the way through to stuffie pick up, I'll share everything that went into making it all happen!

Speaker



Tori Lee

Mobile Library Coordinator | Williston Community Library

The Whole Kit and Caboodle: Creating Circ Sustainable Story Time Kits To-Go:

10:30 AM – 11:00 AM

As a transition out of our in-home daycare visits, Ready to Read and Go Story Time Kits were created as a supplemental way for daycares to continue offering quality literacy engagements without the direct assistance/supervision of a Youth Service staffer at their sites. However, these kits are not just exclusive to daycares - they are available and accessible to all patrons for check-out. Learn how WFPL planned, created and executed the creation of their Ready to Read and Go Story Time Kits that are rarely seen on the shelves because they are out living their best lives with daycare, homeschool, and tiny patron families.

Speaker



Sarah Davis

Children's Services Librarian | West Fargo Public Library

Are Graphic Novels Even Real Books

11:00 AM – 12:00 PM | Location: Oriole

The validity of the graphic novel format is regularly questioned and, unfortunately, it is often perceived as "less than" more traditional formats. This session will highlight examples of and arguments for the validity and "literary-ness" of the graphic novel format. Attendees will leave the session with an understanding of the graphic novel format as "more than."

Speaker



Aimee Rogers

Library Media Specialist | Grand Forks Public Schools/South Middle School

Beyond the stacks: strengthening cross-department partnerships

11:00 AM – 12:00 PM | Location: Pheasant

Libraries don't operate in isolation—we're part of a larger institution, whether it's a city government, a university, a school district, or a corporate setting. But collaborating with departments outside the library—such as IT, facilities, HR, marketing, or administration—can be challenging. Differing priorities, work styles, and even vocabulary can create roadblocks that slow down progress.

This session will provide library staff with practical strategies for working effectively with non-library and library colleagues. Learn how to build relationships, communicate in ways that resonate, and align library initiatives with broader organizational goals. Through real-world examples and interactive discussions, participants will leave with actionable tools to foster stronger partnerships and break down silos.

Speakers



Tricia Andrews

ILS Administrator | Metropolitan Library System



Kirsten Bryson

Collection Services Manager | Metropolitan Library System

Building the ILL Bridge: Connecting Libraries Across North Dakota

11:00 AM – 12:00 PM | Location: Hawk

In this session, the State Library and ODIN will provide an update on the development and implementation of the ILL Bridge, a statewide interlibrary loan system designed to enhance resource sharing across North Dakota. Attendees will learn about the project's goals, challenges, and successes, as well as its impact on library services and community access to information. Join us to discover how the ILL Bridge will transform how libraries across the state collaborate and connect our collections.

Speakers



Jason Bedsaul

Director of ODIN; Library Systems Administrator and Developer | NDUS- Online Dakota Information Network (ODIN)



Mary Soucie

State Librarian | North Dakota State Library

Implementing AI with Intention: What Managers and Staff Need to Know

11:00 AM – 12:00 PM | Location: Bluebird/Finch

As Artificial Intelligence becomes more integrated into our library systems and our work, how can we ensure its responsible and ethical use? This session will explore how libraries can use AI in a way that prioritizes transparency, privacy, and human oversight. We will share Minitex's approach to responsible AI along with implementations from other libraries and organizations, and provide additional resources for developing AI practices and policies at your library. Attendees will leave with a better understanding of their role in implementing AI responsibly in their libraries.

Speakers



Sara Ring

Continuing Education Librarian | Minitex



Greg Argo

Open Education & Affordable Content Librarian | University of Minnesota - Minitex

Innovate & Inspire: A Collaborative Exchange of Library Outreach & Program Ideas

11:00 AM – 12:00 PM | Location: Cardinal/Hummingbird

Libraries thrive on innovation, creativity, and connection. This interactive session is designed to ignite fresh ideas for outreach and programming by combining expert insights with dynamic peer-to-peer exchange. Participants will not only gain inspiration from the presenter's proven outreach initiatives but also have the opportunity to share their own experiences, challenges, and success stories in a collaborative setting.

From engaging hard-to-reach populations to crafting unique events that draw in new audiences, we'll explore inventive ways to bring libraries into the heart of the community. Whether you're looking for fresh program ideas, ways to boost attendance, or innovative partnerships, this session will provide practical takeaways and a network of colleagues eager to collaborate.

Session Highlights

Innovative Ideas: The presenter will share successful outreach and programs that have engaged diverse communities.

Idea Exchange: Attendees will participate in guided discussions and brainstorming sessions to share their own creative approaches.

Collaborative Networking: Build connections with fellow library professionals to spark future partnerships.

Actionable Takeaways: Leave with a collection of program blueprints, outreach strategies, and fresh ideas to implement immediately.

Who Should Attend: This session is ideal for librarians, programming specialists, outreach coordinators, and anyone passionate about expanding the impact of their library through creative, community-driven initiatives.

Let's collaborate, inspire, and transform the way we engage our communities—one innovative idea at a time!

Speaker



April Miller

Access & Outreach Services Librarian | Southwestern Oklahoma State University - Al Harris Library

South Dakota Teen Choice 2025-2026

11:00 AM – 12:00 PM | Location: Eagle

South Dakota librarians will present the High School and Middle School Teen Choice lists for 2025-2026, providing booktalks to share with librarians across the state.

Speakers



Jayde Hart

YARP Chair | SDLA/Young Adult Reading Program Committee



Kris O'Brien

Librarian | Watertown High School Library



Jean Kirschenman

Librarian | Brookings High School Library



Kendra Brewer

Youth Services Librarian | Edith B Siegrist Vermillion Public Library

Luncheon with Awards Banquet

12:00 PM – 1:30 PM | Location: Ballroom

Speaker



Andrea Placher (she/her)

Library Director | Williston Community Library

Public Speaking for Librarians: How to survive presenting to patrons, students, media, elected officials, and beyond.

1:30 PM – 2:30 PM | Location: Oriole

Do you want to be able to give the next *Gettysburg Address* or rally the Troops at Tilbury? Well, we might not be able to help with that, but we can help with how to not have an anxiety attack every time you have to speak to a group of 3 or more people.

Public speaking is an important skill for librarians. It allows us to share knowledge and connect with our community. Whether presenting a new program or advocating for library resources, clear communication is key. By practicing public speaking librarians can become more confident and effective in their roles.

Speakers



Dylan Gonser

Adult Services Librarian -Outreach Lead | Grand Forks Public Library



Andrea Placher (she/her)

Library Director | Williston Community Library



Aimee Rogers

Library Media Specialist | Grand Forks Public Schools/South Middle School



Tonya Palmer

Patron Services Supervisor | Grand Forks Public_



Kristen Borysewicz

Interim Head of Ask Us and Reference | University of North Dakota

Playing to your Strengths and Weaknesses Through Volunteering in the Profession

1:30 PM – 2:30 PM | Location: Pheasant

Librarians and archivists do a lot of talking about the importance of service or volunteering in the profession, but with so many opportunities available it can be difficult to know where to focus your attention. Join Mary and Erin, two seasoned players in the profession with plenty of experience with taking on too much and learning how to set priorities and boundaries, to examine how to leverage service to the profession to develop your own strengths and weaknesses and move forward in your career as a librarian or archivist. From the benefits to different levels of work, we'll help you imagine and plot your own sustainable path towards making a difference in librarianship.

Speakers



Erin Renee Wahl

Dr. | New Mexico State University



Mary Soucie

State Librarian | North Dakota State Library

Serving All Students with a Little Help From AI

1:30 PM – 2:30 PM | Location: Hawk

We will discuss ideas, resources, and strategies for serving diverse populations, such as ELL and Special Ed. We will present ideas for using AI for reader advisory and collaboration, along with incorporating AI into research in an ethical manner. We'll finish with time for sharing best practices, so brainstorm ideas of what has worked for you!

Speakers



Jean Kirschenman

Librarian | Brookings High School Library



Kris O'Brien

Librarian | Watertown High School Library

Integrating Computer Science in the Humanities

1:30 PM – 2:30 PM | Location: Bluebird/Finch

Let's dive into the ND Computer Science & Cybersecurity Standards, identify overlaps with humanities standards, and discover how to fuse the two using books and materials already in your classroom!

Speaker



Katie Larson

Information Technology Specialist | NDIT-EduTech

No More Empty Rooms: Planning Teen Programs That Fill Seats & Build Community

1:30 PM – 2:30 PM | Location: Cardinal/Hummingbird

Are your teen programs missing their target audience? If you've ever planned an event only to have low (or no) attendance, you're not alone! This session will focus on designing programs that actually appeal to teens—by centering their interests, removing barriers to participation, and using creative marketing strategies. Learn how to balance structured and casual programming, harness teen input, and make your events the place to be. Walk away with fresh ideas, real-world examples, and a renewed approach to teen programming that works.

Speaker



Prairie Hanson

Youth Services Assistant | Edith B. Siegrist Vermillion Public Library

Novel Connections: Empowering Community and Growing Engagement through Recreational Reading in Academic Libraries

1:30 PM – 2:30 PM | Location: Eagle

Academic libraries engage their students and user groups with popular reading collections and reading promotion initiatives for myriad reasons—to encourage lifelong learning, to help students reap the benefits of avid reading, to introduce students to library services and personnel through low-stakes interaction, and to increase foot traffic and circulation. Reading enhances critical thinking and writing skills, increases empathy, and can be a way for libraries to support student wellness in high-stress academic environments.

Speakers



Amanda Walch

Director of Libraries | University of Jamestown



Brittany Fischer

Social Sciences & Scholarly Communications Librarian | University of North Dakota



Hannah Beebe

Research & Instruction Librarian | Valley City State University

Break

2:30 PM – 2:45 PM

Keynote: Abby Jimenez

2:45 PM – 4:00 PM | Location: Ballroom

Speaker



Tori Lee

Mobile Library Coordinator | Williston Community Library

Beyond the Books: Building Relationships & Keeping Teens Engaged in Your Library

4:00 PM – 5:00 PM | Location: Oriole

Teens can be one of the toughest audiences to reach—but once they feel seen and valued, they keep coming back. This session will explore practical ways to build meaningful relationships with teens in your library, fostering a sense of belonging that leads to long-term engagement. We'll discuss strategies for making your library a welcoming space, empowering teen voices, and creating low-barrier entry points for participation. Attendees will leave with actionable ideas to connect with teens beyond the books and cultivate a library environment they'll want to return to.

Speaker



Prairie Hanson

Youth Services Assistant | Edith B. Siegrist Vermillion Public Library

Evidence Based Practice for Librarians

4:00 PM – 5:00 PM | Location: Pheasant

The science of Evidence Based Practice (EBP) have been goals of all health science librarians and health professionals for many years. The purpose of this session is to introduce librarians to the world of evidence-based practice and provide individuals familiar with EBP useful information that can be applied in their professional librarianship. Specifically, this session will examine the history, function and purpose of EBP. The session will also provide examples and suggested tools from the National Library of Medicine that researchers and practitioners are able use to enhance their skills in EBP. This session will explain the basics of EBP and highlight essentials of the EBP process such as identifying the problem, forming a question, searching the literature, and evaluating the intervention. One such question includes What are effective interventions health practitioners can use to limit vaccine hesitancy? This is just one example of complex health questions in need of an evidence-based intervention. During this session we will cover additional questions and encourage you to ask your own EBP questions.

Speaker



David Brown

Engagement Specialist | Network of the National Library of Medicine Region 4

Legislative Sessions - What has happened in MPLA states and what could be future challenges

4:00 PM – 5:00 PM | Location: Hawk

Legislative sessions in all states across the MPLA region have become charged with cuts to state library agencies, bills to "lock up librarians", book ratings and more. Learn what has happened in various states and what could be coming in future legislative sessions.

Speakers



Brenda Standiford

Library Development Manager | South Dakota State Library



Mary Soucie

State Librarian | North Dakota State Library



Robin Hastings

Library Services Consultant | Northeast Kansas Library System



Maggie Snow

Director | Minitex



George Seamon

Teeter Tots: Creating Stationed Based Story Time

4:00 PM – 5:00 PM | Location: Bluebird/Finch

Teeter Tots was born from the need to alleviate West Fargo Public Library's ever-growing story time numbers and tame the toddlers! This story time offering is for those transitional aged story time goers that have grown out of a baby lap sit story time, but are not quite ready for a full-blown sit and listen story time. This session will talk about introducing stationed based exploration to your toddler aged wigglers and their preschool cohorts. Learn how WFPL embraced the chaos and created a successful and sustainable story time offering that even parents are excited to attend.

Speaker



Sarah Davis

Children's Services Librarian | West Fargo Public Library

The Heart of Hospitality

4:00 PM – 5:00 PM | Location: Cardinal/Hummingbird

The Heart of Hospitality

In this interactive 50-minute course, we'll explore how hospitality goes beyond service to create memorable, meaningful experiences for our guests. Through discussion, real-life examples, and practical insights, we'll examine the difference between transactional service and true hospitality—where connection, empathy, and excellence intersect.

Participants will:

- Reflect on personal and observed "hospitality wins."
- Discover how small actions, like using a guest's name, can leave a lasting impression.
- Explore strategies for balancing efficiency with genuine care.
- Learn core principles, including "The Siouxland Way," and how they shape our culture.

We'll also dive into practical techniques such as First Contact Resolution, effective roving, and the importance of merchandising to create a welcoming environment. Whether you're new to the concept or just need a refresher, this session will equip you with the tools to consistently deliver exceptional experiences.

Come ready to participate, reflect, and share!

Speakers



Daniel Neeves

Library Assistant Director | Siouxland Libraries



Leah Tanis

Library Associate | Siouxland Libraries

Think Fast, Search Smart: Finding Quality Articles in a Hurry

4:00 PM – 5:00 PM | Location: Eagle

In fast-paced clinical and academic environments, it's not enough to simply retrieve articles—you need to find the right evidence, quickly assess its quality, and begin synthesizing it effectively. This interactive session will guide participants through a streamlined, practical approach to article retrieval that incorporates critical appraisal and lays the groundwork for evidence synthesis. Perfect for librarians supporting evidence-based practice, clinicians, or researchers short on time but high on standards.

Speaker



Maggie Shawcross

Teaching and Learning Librarian | University of Northern Colorado

Vendor Social

5:30 PM – 6:30 PM | Location: Ballroom

Library Tour & Reception: Chester Fritz Library

7:30 PM – 8:30 PM | Location: 3051 University Ave, Grand Forks, ND 58202

MPLA President's Reception

8:00 PM – 10:00 PM

Speaker



Robin Hastings

Library Services Consultant | Northeast Kansas Library System

Friday, October 03, 2025

Keynote: Neal Shusterman

9:00 AM – 10:15 AM | Location: Ballroom

Speaker



Andrea Placher (she/her)

Library Director | Williston Community Library

MPLA Chew and Chat LIVE

10:00 AM – 10:00 AM | Location: Hawk

Join Mary and Jake for a special edition of Chew and Chat

Speakers



Mary Soucie

State Librarian | North Dakota State Library



Jake Rundle

Library Manager | Pikes Peak Library District

Book Bytes: computer science books for the classroom

10:15 AM – 11:15 AM | Location: Oriole

This session will explore a selection of engaging and age-appropriate books that make learning computer science fun and accessible for young learners. We will review children's books, connect them to lessons from CYBER.ORG's Cybersecurity Basics course and the computer science framework, and show how to integrate them into your classroom.

Speakers



Jill Baird

Information Technology Specialist | NDIT-EduTech



Jacqueline Schaible

Information Technology Specialist | NDIT-EduTech

Breaking Down Silos: Collaborating within Academic Libraries

10:15 AM – 11:15 AM | Location: Pheasant

Colleges and universities often have a variety of librarians and information professionals spread throughout campus. This can cause services to become siloed, and students and faculty don't always know the services available through each or even the difference between the different departments. Librarians and information professionals can even become siloed in their own specialties. To help eliminate these barriers, UND librarians worked together to host programming for all university affiliates. Staff from the main library, School of Medicine & Health Sciences library, and law library provided cross-promotion which worked to not only include people from all over the university but also showed them what the different libraries do. Presenters will explain the details of these collaborations, discuss tips for implementing similar programs, and also share how working together helped library staff expand their own knowledge and skills.

Speakers



Devon Olson

Research & Education Librarian | UND School of Medicine & Health Sciences Library Resources



Sara Westall

Clinical Campus Librarian | UND School of Medicine & Health Sciences Library Resources

What Can Your Library Association Do for You

10:15 AM – 11:15 AM | Location: Bluebird/Finch

In this session, Robin, Randi, Elizabeth, and Cicely will talk about the library associations they represent - MPLA, NDLA, SDLA, and NLA respectively - and give an overview of the sort of benefits you can expect to get from membership in each of them. Hear the kinds of things each association is able to do for their members and how being active in your chosen association can benefit you professionally and personally.

Speakers



Robin Hastings

Library Services Consultant | Northeast Kansas Library System



Cicely Douglas

MPLA Rep SD | MPLA



Elizabeth Fox

Lobbying for Libraries | South Dakota State University



Randi Monley

Children's Librarian | Minot Public Library

Navigating Collection Review and Material Access in an Era of Book Challenges

10:15 AM – 11:15 AM | Location: Cardinal/Hummingbird

With increasing legislative attention on public library collections, library staff must adapt policies and procedures to comply with evolving regulations. This session will provide guidance on meeting the requirements of HB1205 (2023), while also preparing for potential new legislation (SB 2307) that could significantly alter how libraries handle access to adult and controversial materials.

Participants will explore best practices for developing and implementing collection review policies that align with legislation while maintaining intellectual freedom and community trust. We will also discuss potential strategies for responding to future legislation, including considerations for shelving, signage, and access restrictions. This presentation will be supplemented by materials provided by ALA's Office of Intellectual Freedom.

Speaker



Jackson Harper

NDLA Intellectual Freedom Committee Chair | NDLA Intellectual Freedom Committee

Tech-less Teens: Programs to Unplug and Engage Teens

10:15 AM – 11:15 AM | Location: Eagle

Many people assume that teens are only interested in their phones and other forms of technology. However, in my time developing and running teen programs at the Brookings Public Library, I've discovered that teens are far more interested in programs that let them put their phones away and actively participate in something. As a result, I've developed a slate of programs designed to help teens do just that: immerse themselves in an activity that doesn't involve screens. These programs include cooking programs, craft programs, and book clubs, just to name a few. This presentation would detail the specific programs, how they're planned and executed, and why teens love them.

Speaker



Jenny Kluck

Young Adult Services Coordinator | Brookings Public Library

Snack Break

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

Lightning Rounds

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM | Location: Oriole

Inside the Cover: Ten Helpful Insights from a Children's Author and Librarian and 3D Print Your Outreach

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

Inside the Cover - As a traditionally published children's author and children's services librarian, I will give attendees ten helpful insights from my experiences in the worlds of writing, publishing, and librarianship. In my session, I will help librarians understand how authors submit manuscripts and receive assignments from publishers, how length and style are determined, how series are developed, how the editor, designer, and illustrator work (and don't work) together, and also how librarians can contact authors for programs, including on-site visits and virtual presentations. My interactive presentation includes examples of drafts, edits, and proofs (hard copy and slides). Time for Q&A will also be available. 3D Print Your Outreach - This presentation focuses on the practical application of 3D printing for the purposes outreach. Guidelines on specifications for 3D prints for outreach will be provided. Specific examples will be discussed, along with files provided for attendees. Examples include: branded bookmarks, small books, lithophanes, keychains, prize wheels for tabling, and more! The process for sourcing models, both by creating your own or by finding them online, as well as modifying existing files will be discussed as additional avenues of approach.

Speakers



Jean L.S. Patrick

Children's Author and Librarian | Mitchell Public Library



Nathan Camp

Emerging Technologies Librarian | New Mexico State University

The Evolution of Audiobooks: How Madison Public Library Transitioned to Digital-Only

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

Is Baseball Underrepresented - cancelled.

The thrust of my study for this poster session is for assessing the baseball holdings contained in public libraries. In particular, how well does the public library in my hometown [i.e. Sioux Falls, South Dakota] contain some of these classics in their holdings. Sioux Falls' population is now 220,000 people. The Siouxland holdings will then be compared to the public library holdings of seven midwestern cities (i.e. Lincoln, Nebraska; Saint Paul, Minnesota; Des Moines, Iowa; Fort Wayne, Indiana; Madison, Wisconsin; Overland Park, Kansas and Springfield, Missouri) whose populations is between 170,000 and 320,000 people.

At least five(5) lists have been generated over the last 30 years as being the 100 greatest books written about baseball. My study utilizes 205 published books gleaned from: (i) a 2018 list that ESQUIRE MAGAZINE compiled; (ii) Rob Kaplan's outstanding annotated bibliography (2013); and finally (iii) a Facebook group exists devoted to baseball books in which its membership selected what they see as the best books published in this genre.

The online public access computer systems or OPACs of the eight libraries will be queried for the 205 titles. My hope is to discover a variety of trends involving this genre. Evolution of Audiobooks - Discover how Madison Public Library transitioned from physical to digital-only audiobooks. This session will highlight steps taken, challenges overcome, and benefits of making the switch to a fully digital audiobook collection, including patron feedback and engagement. Perfect for libraries considering a similar change.

Speaker



Melanie Argo

Systems Librarian | Madison Public Library

"Rethinking Wikipedia from a Library Perspective and What to Keep? Physical Collections in a Digital World What to Keep? Physical Collections in a Digital World"

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

As information professionals, how do we think about Wikipedia? What are we telling our patrons and students? With the rise of generative AI, the time has come to re-evaluate our approach to this critical information resource, whether at the reference desk or in the classroom.

Speakers



Nathan Sonnenschein

User Services & Experience Librarian | Montana State University Billings



Kelly Kornkven

Library Director | Mayville State University

Feed and Read: Summer Snack Program and The Art and Skill of Hosting Online Events

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

Feed and Read - The Feed & Read Snack Program at the Huron Public Library was launched in 2024 to support youth literacy and address food insecurity by providing healthy snacks alongside reading activities throughout the summer. As a partnership with the United Way Backpack Program—which serves children during the school year—Feed & Read was created to help fill the summer gap and ensure kids continue to receive nourishment when school is out. Our presentation will outline the steps we took to get the program off the ground, share key partnerships and funding sources, and reflect on the successes and challenges of the first two years. Attendees will gain practical insights into launching a similar program in their own communities. Art and Skill of Hosting Online Events - Virtual events have become the norm since the pandemic rapidly drove everyone from offline to online. However, as many have learned, hosting a successful online event is both an art and a skill that requires refinement. With five years of experience in creating and managing online events, the speaker will share practical tips and strategies for hosting engaging and seamless virtual events—whether for professional development or public programming. This session will cover key aspects such as securing speakers, troubleshooting technology challenges, and fostering attendee participation while maintaining a positive and professional environment.

Speakers



Angela Bailey

Library Director | Huron Public Library



Shay Beezley

Assistant Director, Metadata & Cataloging | University of Central Oklahoma

Poster Sessions

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM | Location: Ballroom

Applying Social Science Methods to Evaluate AI-Generated Metadata

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

This presentation explores how established social science research methodologies can effectively evaluate AI-generated metadata quality. Beginning in the spring of 2023, the author began a project to create diverse types of metadata, evaluate it, and implement it on library websites and in library systems. She discovered creating metadata was not difficult, but it was difficult to determine the quality and accuracy of the metadata. How good did the metadata need to be to share it with patrons?

This presentation will explore multiple evaluation methods and the results of these methods. The first evaluation methods include case studies and observational techniques to analyze how well generative AI could assign Dewey classifications and Library of Congress subject headings to physical books.

The next methodological approach includes quantitative assessment using rubrics and qualitative investigation through surveys and interviews. Student workers created abstracts and keywords for electronic theses and dissertations and then evaluated their own work using these approaches.

Finally, the presentation will explore the use of comparative analysis to see if human-created, AI-created or human assisted by AI metadata is superior. Future research seeks to evaluate the quality of AI-created metadata by subject and to see if cases of bias occur.

Speaker



Jenny Bodenhamer

Assistant Department Head | Oklahoma State University

Combatting Imposter Syndrome in a New Library Position

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

This past year, Karlene moved into a reference position and went through a period of self doubt. This presentation will provide resources for others going through transitions at work, including academic resources and ways to calm and reassure yourself.

Speaker



Karlene Clark

Education and Human Services Librarian | University of North Dakota

Escape Rooms for Teens

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

How to write your own library appropriate escape room or borrow mine!

Speaker



Pam Carswell

Teen Librarian | Minot Public Library

AI Literacy Starts Here: Supporting Students and Patrons with Confidence

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

Artificial Intelligence isn't just the future—it's today's opportunity for educators and librarians to lead with curiosity, clarity, and care. This poster session introduces practical, educator-friendly AI tools that support instruction, engagement, and digital literacy across school and public library settings.

What you'll discover:

- Easy-to-use AI tools for lesson planning, resource creation, and library programming
- Curated resources to teach AI literacy to students and patrons
- Opportunities to bring this presentation to your school or library—customized for your community

Whether you're AI-curious or ready to dive in, this poster session offers hands-on ideas, inclusive strategies, and a warm invitation to explore AI with confidence.

Speaker



Lesley Allan

Instructional Design and Development Coordinator | Fables and Fabrications

How to hold an Acrylic Paint Pour program

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

Acrylic paint pouring is a style of painting that saw a rise in popularity in the mid-2010's and it a great way for anyone to try their hand at art, even if they "don't feel like they're creative or an artist." I like to encourage everyone to give paint pouring a try because you don't need to be an artist to enjoy the process of making art. It involves thinning down paint and adding simple "ingredients" such as glue, to make acrylic paint flow freely. It can be done using inexpensive supplies and patrons are always impressed by their creations. The possible outcomes of a paint pour are endless and unique. A wide variety of age ranges can participate in paint pouring, one summer we modified the activity to be a mini paint pouring kit as a take & make for our patrons. My poster would detail the supplies needed, and the ideal way to set up your space for a successful paint pour, along with examples of previous paint pours.

Speaker



Brandy Helm

Information Services Associate | Grand Forks Public Library

If You Host It - Will They Come? Lessons from a year of programming in an academic library

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

The poster will provide a look at three new library programs that were introduced to students at Dakota State University in the Fall 2024 semester. Poster will detail how the library prepped for the programs, how things proceeded over the academic year, and both failures and successes of each program. A final section will offer takeaways and changes that could be made in the future. The programs were a textiles/fabrics group, a writing group (separate from the writing center on campus), and a young adult book club.

Speaker



Taylor Cline

Library Associate | Dakota State University

ND Dept. of Public Instruction, Legendary Learners

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

Speaker



Taylor Olsen

ND Dept. of Public Instruction

Making the Federal Case: The Arc of North Dakota, Disability Rights, and Advocacy

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

In 1980, The Arc of North Dakota sued the state of North Dakota in U.S. Federal District Court regarding the treatment of, and conditions surrounding, the nature of care of North Dakotans with intellectual and developmental disabilities in the Grafton State School and the San Haven State Hospital. When the case was closed in 1996, it brought about fundamental and long-lasting changes across the state.

In 2024, The Arc of North Dakota chose to deposit their records related to the lawsuit with the Elwyn B. Robinson Department of Special Collections at the University of North Dakota's Chester Fritz Library. Special Collections already holds the papers of Judge Bruce Van Sickle, the federal judge presiding over the case, as well as the papers of several state politicians involved with the case. The addition of the Arc's collection represents an unprecedented opportunity to document the legal case, and subsequent changes, surrounding the state of North Dakota's treatment of the intellectually and developmentally disabled.

Through this poster, the presenters will examine how the collection originated, the initial discussions surrounding the archival donation, and possible future growth of the collection, hopefully including donations from individuals with lived experience or their families. The presenters will also share how the collections support the strategic goals of the University of North Dakota.

Promoting Poetry in Your Library

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

Poetry often represents a small section in libraries and may be overlooked by all but the most dedicated poetry enthusiasts. This sometimes leaves many poetry sections devoid of more recent modern poets. This poster seeks to encourage and inform on how to build up poetry collections by recommending modern poets and how to grow a reader base along the way with events and displays.

Speaker



Laura Kroeker

Library Associate | Rapid City Public Library

Providing Comprehensive Library Access for Hybrid and Remote Researchers

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

As hybrid and remote work continues, special libraries are continually evolving to meet the needs of their communities. This includes remote and hybrid researchers at the University of North Dakota's Energy & Environmental Research Center (EERC). While the EERC is physically located in eastern North Dakota, EERC employees are scattered throughout MPLA states. Using embedded librarianship principles, the EERC's Library & Information Services team fulfills complex and time-sensitive information needs by providing creative solutions and building partnerships with researchers.

Speaker



Tressa M Graves

Librarian & Archivist | University of North Dakota. Energy & Environmental Research Center

Strategies for Combatting Health Misinformation

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

- While health misinformation has existed nearly since humans started practicing medicine, the strategies by which health misinformation spreads have changed in the age of social media, allowing for misinformation and conspiracies to spread more widely and cause more harm. While systemic changes are needed to lessen the societal impact of health misinformation, there are also actions we can take in our day to day lives, both personally and professionally, to help decrease the spread of health misinformation.

- Outline

- A brief history of health misinformation
- Current methods of spread
- A review of the literature on actions to decrease the spread of health misinformation
- Actions individuals can take to decrease the spread of health misinformation

Speaker



Caroline Allen

Librarian | University of Iowa Healthcare, Department of Ophthalmology and Visual Sciences

Tell Me More: Demystifying Medical Librarianship

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

Medical and health sciences librarians make up approximately 21% of the entire library profession, yet many are unsure of what this specialized area of librarianship looks like. Others may be new to the profession or looking for a change in discipline and are hesitant to pursue an area of librarianship that seems to require experience of a knowledge base they are interested in, but do not have specialized skills required to fill their roles in providing health information. This session aims to: introduce attendees to what the pathway to medical librarianship might look like, provide information about the types of education and training needed and where to find it, and explore examples of potential settings and roles individuals can find themselves in, and to encourage and empower attendees by providing some resources and tools they can use to pursue a career as medical librarians.

Speaker



Ruby Nugent

Biomedical Research Librarian | National Jewish Health Tucker Medical Library

The (Library) Magic of a Stuffy Sleepover

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

For fans of children's programming and Toy Story. This poster will show and describe how I went about planning and executing a Stuffy Sleepover event at the Williston Community Library. From preparation tactics and marketing the event, to day-of jitters, all the way through to stuffie pick up, I'll share everything that went into making it all happen!

Speaker



Tori Lee

Mobile Library Coordinator | Williston Community Library

The Whole Kit and Caboodle: Creating Circ Sustainable Story Time Kits To-Go:

11:15 AM – 11:45 AM

As a transition out of our in-home daycare visits, Ready to Read and Go Story Time Kits were created as a supplemental way for daycares to continue offering quality literacy engagements without the direct assistance/supervision of a Youth Service staffer at their sites. However, these kits are not just exclusive to daycares - they are available and accessible to all patrons for check-out. Learn how WFPL planned, created and executed the creation of their Ready to Read and Go Story Time Kits that are rarely seen on the shelves because they are out living their best lives with daycare, homeschool, and tiny patron families.

Speaker



Sarah Davis

Children's Services Librarian | West Fargo Public Library

Developing Community Engagement and Partnerships for Strong Programming

11:45 AM – 12:45 PM | Location: Oriole

How can we better engage our communities and foster both current and new partnerships to build strong, effective programs in our libraries? Let's come together to discuss these ideas and brainstorm.

With years of experience working with libraries, I've seen firsthand the importance of community engagement and building meaningful partnerships.

In smaller and rural libraries, there's often a strong desire to collaborate and brainstorm ways to engage our communities more effectively. So, let's explore some key questions:

- What community engagement opportunities or programs have worked well at your library, and how did you measure their success?
- What programs haven't been as successful? Were you able to pinpoint why they didn't meet expectations?
- How can we build stronger partnerships and more impactful programs going forward?

Let's come together to share insights and explore new ideas!

Speaker



Cassandra Osterloh

Tribal Libraries Program Coordinator | New Mexico State Library

Experience Passes for Circulation

11:45 AM – 12:45 PM | Location: Pheasant

I would like to talk about the collection of Experience Passes our library has been able to curate over the past year. The goal was to have passes that would cover or reduce the cost of entry for adults and kids into local and state-wide museums and educational centers. With inflation and cost of living continuously going up it can make it hard for families to afford necessities, let alone spending additional money to go to a museum. This is our small start to a library of things that didn't take up a lot of space.

Speaker



Jade Praus

Children's & Youth Services Librarian | Dickinson Area Public Library

Library Ecosystems in Action: Speaking with One Voice

11:45 AM – 12:45 PM | Location: Hawk

The Library Ecosystem is an interconnected network of all types of libraries: academic, public, and school libraries. Learn how the ecosystem initiative has been used in several states for legislative cohesiveness and advocacy effectiveness. Then, take back practical steps and tools to build cohesion and activate advocacy partners in your community. This interactive session will provide attendees with details about the One Voice: Library Ecosystem Toolkit developed by the ALA Library Ecosystem Task Force.

Speaker



Sara Kelly Johns

Instructor | Syracuse University iSchool, School Library Program

Transitioning From Graphic Novels to Chapter Books

11:45 AM – 12:45 PM | Location: Cardinal/Hummingbird

In "Transitioning Graphic Novels Readers to Chapter Books" we will explore the vital role graphic novels play in enhancing reading skills and fostering a love for literature. If you've ever encountered the misconception that graphic novels are less valuable than traditional texts, this session is for you! Discover how these engaging stories can serve as a stepping stone for young readers, helping them build confidence and fluency as they transition to chapter books. I will share effective strategies for guiding readers through this process, ensuring they not only embrace new challenges but also enjoy the journey of reading. Don't miss this opportunity to empower the next generation of readers!

Speaker



Kathy Cline

School Library Specialist | North Dakota State Library

Understanding AI Literacy

11:45 AM – 12:45 PM | Location: Eagle

Everyone is talking about AI and how it is changing our world, but few people are talking about AI literacy. AI literacy includes being aware of and understanding AI technology in practical applications; applying and using AI technology for accomplishing tasks proficiently; being able to analyze, select, and critically evaluate the data and information provided by AI; and developing awareness of one's own personal responsibilities and respect for reciprocal rights and obligations. Presenters will discuss AI literacy across demographics and how algorithms and AI have, and continue, to influence communications and online information access.

Speakers



Janet Anderson

Clinical Campus Librarian | UND School of Medicine & Health Sciences



Devon Olson

Research & Education Librarian | UND School of Medicine & Health Sciences Library Resources



Sara Westall

Clinical Campus Librarian | UND School of Medicine & Health Sciences Library Resources

"Using the Crowd: How Crowdsourcing Can Improve Accessibility"

11:45 AM – 12:45 PM | Location: Bluebird/Finch

Digitization is about more than imaging. It can also be about using human and machine-readable pathways and discovery systems to broaden access to the widest range of users. In the past, the digitization of archival collections focused on capturing and accessing images of items such as hand-written material. In the current cultural heritage environment, providing access to images of archival textual material alone is not enough. Today's archival collections need to be searchable and transcribable. This session will discuss how the University Libraries uses technology such as OCR and AI and uses the public to explore and transcribe digitized texts. How archives are using crowdsourcing digitized transcripts with students, staff and the public will be discussed.

Speaker



Danielle De Jager-Loftus

Associate Professor, Technology/Art, Music, Theatre Librarian | University Libraries, University of South Dakota

Luncheon & Keynote: Molly Yeh

12:45 PM – 2:00 PM | Location: Ballroom

Speaker



Karlene Clark

Education and Human Services Librarian | University of North Dakota

"Caught in the Web: How Algorithms Affect Our Online Experience"

2:00 PM – 3:00 PM | Location: Oriole

I will talk about how browser and social media algorithms can drastically affect the content that we see online. Algorithms learn what kind of information we like and eventually only show us that kind of information, even if it is not real. Everything we do online is interconnected in ways we may be unaware of, and that means the filter can follow us wherever we go online. I will show examples of how this works, and some ways to avoid the filter bubble so that we can all be well informed and start to see more of what we've been missing.

Speaker



Shari Theroux

Systems & Discovery Librarian | South Dakota State University

Got a sticky situation? Let's figure it out - together!

2:00 PM – 3:00 PM | Location: Pheasant

Our community of practice (that's academic lingo for long-term-partners) has been meeting since 2015, talking through personal and professional opportunities, challenges, and triumphs. This level of trust supports our ultimate mission to facilitate communication between our three library organizations (public, community college and doctoral-granting university) to best serve our communities and organizations. This interactive presentation will be a chance for attendees to join our community to discover solutions to library-life conundrums (a mix of ours, those submitted in advance*, and in-person). This is an opportunity to be mentored "on the fly" by three very different librarians with varied backgrounds and experiences, and to offer your own insights to others.

* conundrums shared in advance will be anonymized. Please send them to us through Whova or to our email addresses listed in the presenter information.

Learning Objectives:

Attendees will:

- Be able to contribute to solutions for others
- Learn ways to share ideas without owning the answer
- Cultivate a sense of detachment from perplexing, personal problems ; maintain awareness that what works for one person does not necessarily work for another(?)

Speakers



Annie Epperson

U of N Colorado University Libraries



Elena Rosenfeld

Community Engagement & Strategies Manager | High Plains Library District



Carol Satersmoen

Acquisitions/Cataloging Librarian | Aims Community College

Making the Most of Your ILS: A Strategic Review

2:00 PM – 3:00 PM | Location: Hawk

Is your Integrated Library System (ILS) still meeting the needs of your library and patrons? Evaluating your ILS can be an overwhelming task. In this session, we'll explore how to evaluate your current ILS, identify strengths and weaknesses, and determine whether it's time for an upgrade or a switch. We'll discuss key performance metrics, staff and user feedback, and toss in some project management to guide the process.

Speaker



Tricia Andrews

ILS Administrator | Metropolitan Library System

Supervisor Support Group

2:00 PM – 3:00 PM | Location: Cardinal/Hummingbird

A round table discussion for front-line supervisors to share the best practices, as well as the challenges that come with being the supervisor of a patron-facing department and ideas for overcoming them. First-time supervisors are especially welcome.

Speakers



Tonya Palmer

Patron Services Supervisor | Grand Forks Public_



Erica Sodeyama

Adult Services Director | Grand Forks Public_



Aaron Stefanich

Children's Services Director | Grand Forks Public Library

What the WCAG is a VPAT?!? Understanding and Navigating Accessibility Rule Changes for Public Websites and Apps

2:00 PM – 3:00 PM | Location: Eagle

Join us for an update on the latest ADA rule changes regarding web content and mobile app accessibility. We'll discuss the new requirements set forth by the Department of Justice, focusing on how state and local governments can ensure their digital services are accessible to all and working with vendors to gather the necessary documents. Learn about the practical steps for compliance and the positive impact these changes will have on inclusivity and accessibility.

Speakers



Jason Bedsaul

Director of ODIN; Library Systems Administrator and Developer | NDUS- Online Dakota Information Network (ODIN)



Jeremy Wegener

ODIN

Southwestern Academic Library Deans and Directors' Perspectives of Sustainability

2:00 PM – 3:00 PM | Location: Bluebird/Finch

This presentation takes Wahl's 2024 dissertation and revisits the data using the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals as a main framework, in addition to the ALA adopted three-legged-stool framework. Exploring the sustainability perspectives of public institution academic library deans and directors in the Southwestern United States, this research aims to understand how those leading our libraries see their roles and their libraries roles in sustainability.

Speaker



Erin Renee Wahl

Dr. | New Mexico State University

"Engaging Unattended Youth in the Library: Building a Positive Library Environment for All "

3:00 PM – 4:00 PM | Location: Oriole

Working in a public library next to public schools brings many opportunities. Having dozens of unattended elementary aged students and teens in the library also poses unique challenges to keeping the public library space an inviting space for all guests. Amy and Claire have worked together to implement procedures and programs with proven results to create a library space for everyone. This presentation will focus on building relationships and planning programs. It will also address the importance of staffing levels, strategically positioning staff during the afterschool hours, and the need for staff to present a united front in consistency and expectations. Additionally, the presentation will touch on ways to meet the needs of adult patrons during the busy afterschool time as well. Implementing these successful measures has allowed the library to celebrate being a cornerstone of the active neighborhood for all patrons.

Speakers



Amy Larsen

Branch Librarian | Siouxland Libraries



Claire Jeanson

Library Associate | Siouxland Libraries

Growing Up Wild for Libraries

3:00 PM – 4:00 PM | Location: Pheasant

Enjoy Growing Up Wild activities and be inspired to use them in your library. Growing Up WILD is an early childhood education curriculum (children ages 3-7) that builds on children's sense of wonder about nature and invites them to explore wildlife and the world around them. The activity guide features 27 field-tested, hands-on, nature-based, ready-made thematic units and over 400 experiences in a full-color activity guide. The guide includes outdoor explorations, scientific inquiry, art projects, music and movement, conservation activities, reading and math connections and "Healthy Me" extensions. It is correlated to the National Association for the Education of Young Children (NAEYC) Standards and the Head Start Domains.

Speakers



Dr. Laura Munki

Executive Director | Dakota Science Center



Delores Clark

STEM Coordinator (GFPL) and Education Development Coordinator (DSC) | Grand Forks Public Library and Dakota Science Ce...

Minutes Back in Your Day

3:00 PM – 4:00 PM | Location: Hawk

A well-run meeting is a thing of beauty. And it gives everyone involved time back in their day to *not* be in meetings. Learn why knowing just enough of Robert's Rules of Order is a super-power, the joy of an agenda, and how to add minutes to your life.

Speaker



John Rodenbiker

Board Member, Vice Chair | Fargo Public Library

"Using the Koha open source ILS in a large consortial environment"

3:00 PM – 4:00 PM | Location: Bluebird/Finch

I will discuss the benefits of using the Koha open source integrated library system in a regional or state-wide library consortium. I will talk about the history of the Koha project, its open source nature, and the advantages that come from moving your data into a stable open source environment.

Speaker



George Williams

Next Search Catalog Coordinator | Northeast Kansas Library System

"What Works: Research Results of the Development of a Consensus Model for Collaboration"

3:00 PM – 4:00 PM | Location: Cardinal/Hummingbird

As part of a research team at Plymouth State University (NH), the presenter helped to create and conduct a Delphi Study to develop a Consensus Model of Collaboration for School Librarians. The purpose of the study was to invite review and input from identified experts in school librarianship in order to create an updated and scaffolded model of collaboration that builds on the previous efforts of scholars in the field by identifying more contemporary levels of collaboration and expanding these to include dispositional elements and requisite environmental variables. Come see the model that emerged and learn the results of questions which included:

- What are the key components of an updated model of collaboration in school librarianship that reflects current practices and needs?
- What characteristics should an updated, scaffolded model of collaboration include to address contemporary challenges in school librarianship?
- How can a scaffolded model help guide novice and experienced school librarians in developing more effective partnerships with educators?

Even if you are not in a school library, there are lessons to be shared about the importance of understanding opportunities for collaboration in all library settings.

Speaker



Susan D. Ballard

Consultant & Educator | Independent

Wrangling Library Technology Without Losing Your Mind

3:00 PM – 4:00 PM | Location: Eagle

Libraries rely heavily on technology both old and new to provide services to patrons. Managing that technology can be tricky. Join Robin Hastings, author of the newly released 7th edition of the Neal-Schuman Technology Companion as she discusses the basics of the technologies often used in libraries, with a special section on keeping up with technology in the future included!

Speaker



Robin Hastings

Library Services Consultant | Northeast Kansas Library System